stand against those who would prevent knowledge or information from appearing in the public record. We cannot trust newspapers alone, as they have proved again and again to be both censors and partisans. We cannot trust broadcasters, who show, in most cases, that the value of advertising is more compelling to them than news values. Publishing in the computer age therefore becomes about performing the task that the systems allow and facing down the ingrained, self-protecting habits of the old publishing way. As our work has shown and our ongoing collaborations attest, we are not against the old media. We just forged a position that allowed us to do better publishing on the modern scene than they could do. We work with them because we do not wish to be rivals: we wish to pool resources, but they, as we will see in forthcoming chapters, struggle with the notion of their own legitimacy in the computer age, and with the machinations of their own egos. That is fine. But civilisation, if I may suggest so, is moving on without them. They are dying.

I grew towards WikiLeaks by trying to establish in my mind a science of journalistic honesty. What would keep us honest? I had established infinite deniability of sources when I was a hacker and activist. And now I wondered if this could help people place stories in the public domain? Could a new method of publishing sustain a new way of localising power? It was inevitable, once the heat was on, that the old media institutions would shy from these questions, rush into their habitual dugouts and prepare to denounce me. But none of that matters. The more important issue is to do with how institutions adapt to the new expectations put upon them. When clever young people trust their social media more than they trust their elders, how will institutions prove their virtue? Our fathers took them for granted, but our knowledge, in detail, of how human institutions actually behave across the world in the modern era is very poor.

And that won’t stick any more. People relate to each other, countries relate to each other, ideas relate very differently now that the technology keeps the globe in touch with itself. That’s it, really. All the old hiding places are open to exposure, and the institutions can bark, the military can weep, the *New York Times* can ride its pious high horse, but it won’t change the fact that people want answers now to questions they once didn’t even know were questions. And they know where to look. They know how to talk to each other about the fact that certain public bodies are keeping secrets. As WikiLeaks began to look possible, I started to believe, myself,